

# Teaching Statement

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## Teaching Philosophy

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I believe every student can learn to reason with economic models. I see my role as making the reasoning behind each step easy to follow and making the classroom a place where students feel comfortable trying. I want students to see models as tools for questions they care about. They should be able to state the assumptions in their own words, interpret the conclusions, and ask what evidence would support or challenge them. I therefore treat mathematics as a language for expressing economic reasoning, not as a collection of formulas to be memorized.

Three principles guide my teaching. First, I make the structure of an argument visible. Formal material can feel intimidating at first, and often what helps most is seeing how to approach a problem, not just its final solution. Second, I build solutions together with students, treating every answer, including tentative or incorrect ones, as a useful contribution. Third, I connect theoretical benchmarks to evidence about behavior. An experiment, an empirical example, or a counterexample helps students understand both what a model explains and when its predictions may fail.

These principles reflect the perspective behind my research in behavioral and experimental economics. Theory provides disciplined predictions, and observed choices show how beliefs, reasoning, and social preferences shape behavior. In the classroom, a gap between the two is not merely a complication. It is an opportunity for students to see how economists formulate, test, and revise explanations.

## Making Formal Reasoning Accessible

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I have supported students at the undergraduate, master's, doctoral, and DBA levels as a teaching assistant at Renmin University of China, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen (CUHK Shenzhen), and The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST). My courses at CUHK Shenzhen and HKUST were taught in English to students from diverse backgrounds. As a teaching assistant, I have independently prepared and led tutorials, written notes and problem sets, designed grading rubrics, graded assignments and examinations, held office hours, and answered questions through course platforms.

While completing my master's degree at CUHK Shenzhen, I led weekly tutorials in *Advanced Econometrics II* for doctoral students and in *Introductory Econometrics* for undergraduate students. Because each econometric result builds on earlier definitions and assumptions, I prepared knowledge maps linking definitions, assumptions, and results, so that students could see how the material fit together. I also used worked examples to connect formal notation with verbal intuition, then returned to the formal result to show why each assumption was needed. Rather than asking students to remember an estimator or theorem as an isolated object, I asked what problem it solves, what information it uses, and what would change if an assumption failed. I adjusted the depth of the formal argument to each audience, but the goal was the same: every step should be interpretable.

In *Microeconomic Analysis* for master's students at HKUST, I started each exercise by asking which economic idea was at stake and why a particular theorem or proof method suited the problem. Only then did we solve the specific exercise. Consumer-theory problems, for example, became a chance to connect optimization and comparative statics with what the Slutsky decomposition says about behavior, rather than an exercise in manipulating equations. Students thus reviewed the course material while learning how to apply it in a new setting.

I was glad when several students told me that these tutorials made difficult material clearer. Their comments reinforced a lesson I carry into every course: a tutorial should do more than supply answers. It should help students recognize a structure they can apply on their own to the next problem.

## Building the Solution Together

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I want students to feel that we are building the solution together. During derivations, I pause to ask which result applies, what the next step might be, or how an economic variable should respond to a change. I treat every answer as a useful contribution, including tentative or incorrect ones. A wrong answer often reflects a natural way of thinking about the problem, and discussing why it seems plausible helps the whole class. It also tells me when to slow down and revisit an earlier idea before moving on. Over time, these moments help students go from following an argument to building one themselves, and give them confidence that they can.

As an instructor, I will extend this practice through structured active learning. In microeconomics and game theory, students can make decisions in short strategic environments before seeing the equilibrium analysis. Comparing their predictions, choices, and stated beliefs makes concepts such as dominance, best responses, Bayesian updating, and equilibrium selection concrete. In econometrics, students can predict the consequences of a research-design problem before examining them with simulated or real data. Short polls, small-group problem solving, and prediction-before-solution exercises can make even a large class participatory without sacrificing analytical depth.

## Supporting Students with Different Needs

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Caring about learning also means paying attention to students' circumstances. Students may struggle with the same material for different reasons. One may understand the economic intuition but find the notation unfamiliar; another may be comfortable with mathematics but unsure how to interpret a result; a third may follow a solution but not know how to begin independently. I therefore explain important concepts in several mutually reinforcing ways: formal notation, verbal intuition, worked examples, graphs, and, where useful, computational demonstrations.

Practical constraints matter too. In a master's course at HKUST, some students were completing internships during the day. I scheduled the tutorial in the evening, recorded each session in full, and uploaded the recordings to the course platform. Students could then catch up on a missed session or revisit a difficult derivation at their own pace. Because students come with different backgrounds, I have also prepared additional practice materials, recommended resources suited to their preparation, and offered supplementary online office hours, especially during demanding examination periods. When several students ask for the same kind of help, I treat it as feedback and build more support into later sessions.

As an instructor, I would make this support systematic. Early low-stakes exercises would help me see differences in preparation. Optional review materials would support students who need more mathematical or statistical background without slowing the whole class. Clear rubrics, examples of model reasoning, and discussions of common mistakes would make expectations transparent, and small-group work, anonymous polling, and brief written responses would give students more than one way to participate. Supporting students in this way does not mean lowering expectations. It means giving every student a fair chance to engage with demanding material and to meet shared standards.

## Course Design

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I design a course by first asking what students should be able to do at the end of it. In intermediate microeconomics, students should be able to translate an economic problem into a formal model, derive its implications, and explain the result in economic language. In game theory, they should be able to represent a strategic situation, solve for its equilibria, and judge whether the predicted behavior is plausible. In econometrics, they should be able to move from a research question to an estimand, identify the assumptions required for interpretation, choose an appropriate method, and communicate uncertainty.

Lectures, tutorials, and assessments should all serve these goals. I would combine cumulative problem sets with low-stakes exercises that reveal misunderstandings before a major assessment. Rubrics would distinguish correct calculation, valid reasoning, appropriate interpretation, and clear communication. When returning work, I would explain not only why an answer was incorrect, but also which step in the reasoning

produced the error. In quantitative courses, I would integrate computation with theory. I have used statistical software demonstrations with DBA students, and in future econometrics courses, students could use real and simulated data to see how an assumption affects an estimate and how sampling variation appears across repeated samples. Computation would not replace theory; it would make the implications of the theory visible.

## Courses and Curricular Contributions

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I would be glad to teach microeconomic theory, game theory, and behavioral and experimental economics at the undergraduate and graduate levels, including principles and intermediate microeconomics and behavioral game theory. My teaching experience also prepares me to contribute to introductory, advanced, and applied econometrics, as well as statistics for economics. Decision theory, information economics, and the economics of organizations are natural extensions of my research.

I would especially enjoy developing a course in *Behavioral and Experimental Economics*. Students would begin by making decisions themselves in short classroom experiments, so that each topic starts from their own experience before we derive and discuss the theoretical predictions. When choices depart from a benchmark, I would invite students to propose competing explanations and suggest evidence that could distinguish them. The course would emphasize that behavioral economics is not a catalogue of departures from standard models, but a discipline for formalizing and testing alternative explanations.

For the final group project, students would choose one of two tracks. In the first, they would turn a question they find meaningful into an original experimental design. They would explain the treatment comparison, specify outcomes, and identify which alternative explanations the design could rule out. They would then use simulated data or AI agents as stand-in participants to demonstrate the planned analysis. In the second, they would study the design of an experiment published in a leading journal. Using the original data but treating the treatment effect as unknown, they would build a decision model and run a power analysis as if planning the study themselves. They would then compare their ex ante assessment with the published findings. Both tracks teach students to think like the designers of evidence, not only its consumers.

I would also bring experimental reasoning into econometrics teaching. Students often learn econometrics through completed observational datasets. Asking how data are generated, how to define an estimand, choose outcome measures, determine an appropriate sample size, and pre-specify a transparent analysis, connects econometrics, experimental methods, and formal theory rather than treating them as separate subjects.

## Research Mentoring

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Beyond the classroom, I would be glad to mentor undergraduate and graduate students in research, through theses, independent studies, and course-based projects. As a doctoral student, I have mentored undergraduate and master's students at CUHK Shenzhen and HKUST on a voluntary basis, advising those considering doctoral study on research preparation and graduate applications. As a faculty member, I can help with game-theoretic modeling, experimental design and IRB preparation, oTree programming, power analysis, pre-analysis plans, lab or online experiment protocols, and econometric analysis.

I would begin by listening to what interests each student, then help turn that interest into an answerable question and a feasible approach. Together, we would set milestones suited to the project, such as a model, experimental instructions, a pilot, or an initial analysis. At each stage, I would encourage students to explain and defend their choices. I would step back gradually as they grow into confident, independent researchers.

My aim is for students to leave my courses with both analytical discipline and intellectual independence. Whether they continue to academic research or apply economics in other settings, I want them to see theory and evidence as complementary tools for understanding economic and strategic behavior, and to feel confident that they can use both.